

3.4 Conduct of the speaking test

General information

The assessment must be conducted entirely in French.

The assessment must be conducted in one continuous session.

Use of notes

Students must not take notes with them into the examination. However, they should bring their picture for Task A.

Timings of the tasks

The total assessment time is 8–10 minutes. Students are assessed on the quality of responses, so the length of tasks is representative of their relative demand.

Assessment times for the tasks are as follows.

- Task A: 2 to 3 minutes
- Task B: 3 to 3 minutes 30 seconds
- Task C: 3 to 3 minutes 30 seconds.

Task C should continue without a pause or interruption from Task B.

Tasks B and C should not exceed 7 minutes.

If the assessment time exceeds ten minutes, only the first ten minutes will be assessed.

Randomisation grid

In order to avoid misconduct in centres, teachers will receive randomisation grids three days in advance of the window for the speaking assessment from Pearson.

Based on the topic chosen for the picture-based discussion task, the teacher/examiner will use the randomisation grid to select the discussion topics for the first and second conversation (Tasks B and C).

If conducting more than five tests in a day, return to the beginning of the sequence after the fifth candidate. If conducting tests on more than one day, start each new day at the beginning of the sequence.

Instructions for Task A

Teachers/examiners must ask each candidate five questions in total (plus the allowed prompts – see below). There are five types of questioning which teachers/examiners must cover in the discussion and in the order listed below. Teachers must ensure they ask ONE question from each question type.

Question type 1: A description of what you can see in the picture

Question type 2: Specific factual information about the picture

For example, select a person or persons in the picture and state what they are doing.

Question type 3: Past or future hypothesis

This question must ask the candidate to imagine a possible past or potential future event relating to the picture.

This is the opportunity to support the candidate in using additional tenses and timeframes.

Question type 4: Opinions about the picture

This question elicits the candidate's opinions on the picture and the topic.

Question type 5: Evaluation

The teacher/examiner should elicit an evaluation from the candidate. This question will move away from the content of the picture and exploit the wider topic area.

For examples of these questions, please see the *Sample Assessment Materials* document, which is available on our website. Teachers/examiners must mirror the style of questions in the sample assessment materials but not replicate them.

Prompts

In order to enable candidates to develop their responses, teachers/examiners are allowed to use prompts for questions. Only the following three prompts may be used.

- Pourquoi (pas) ? – Why (not)?
- Autre chose ? – Anything else?
- C'est tout ? – Is that all?

There must be no other supplementary questions and teachers/examiners must not deviate from these prompts.

Instructions for Tasks B and C

For **each** conversation teachers/examiners should:

- ask open questions
- ask questions at an appropriate level for the candidate's ability
- link the questions to the previous response as far as possible
- elicit a range of tenses (past, present and future), structures and vocabulary
- elicit opinions and justifications
- provide candidates with an opportunity to expand
- respect timings.

For examples of these questions, please see the *Sample Assessment Materials* document, which is available on our website. Teachers/examiners must mirror the style of questions in the sample assessment materials but not replicate them.

Recording of candidates' speaking tests

All candidates' speaking tests must be recorded. The centre should keep a copy of all recordings.

Where recordings fail or are unsatisfactory, you must re-examine as soon as possible.

It is essential to check that:

- the microphone and recorder are connected correctly, and recording is taking place
- the position of the microphone favours the candidate and not the examiner
- extraneous noise is kept to a minimum
- the recorder is switched on at the start of the test and off at the end
- Complete, unedited recordings of all assessments must be submitted to Pearson via the Learner Work Transfer (LWT) portal
- the candidate's name and number are announced at the start of each test
- the timing starts when the candidate answers the first assessment question
- the topic area is announced at the beginning of each task.

Interruption of recordings

The recording must not be paused or stopped during a test. If an emergency makes this unavoidable, a report should be written immediately for the Qualification Delivery and Award Manager for French at Pearson. The report must explain the circumstances and any subsequent action taken. A copy of the report must be included with the oral tests sent to the examiner.

Authentication of candidate responses

The teacher/examiner and the candidate must sign the declaration of authentication on the candidate cover sheet which is on the website qualifications.pearson.com. This will always be the most up to date version of the declaration confirming that the work is the candidate's own. Any candidate unable to provide an authentication statement will receive zero marks for the component.